4. Several expert committees and the Second Administrative Reforms Commission of India[1] have also made recommendations for establishing such an agency.

Functions

The NIA is mandated to investigate and prosecute offences under the various Acts mentioned in the Schedule of the NIA Act. In pursuance of its mandate, the NIA collects, collates and analyses counter-terrorism investigation. It also shares inputs with its sister intelligence agencies and law enforcement units both at central and state governments level.

In more detail, the functions assigned to the NIA are as follows[2]:

1. To investigate and prosecute offences in respect of the Acts specified in the Schedule of the NIA Act.

2. To provide assistance to, and seek assistance from, other intelligence and investigation agencies of the central government and state governments.

3. To take other such measures which may be necessary for speedy and effective implementation of the provisions of the NIA Act.

Vision

The following points highlight the vision of the NIA[3]:

1. The NIA aims to be a thoroughly professional investigative agency matching the best international standards.

2. The NIA aims to set the standards of excellence in counter-terrorism and other national security-related investigations at the national level by developing into a highly trained, partnership-oriented workforce.

3. The NIA aims at creating deterrence for existing and potential terrorist groups/individuals.

4. The NIA aims to develop as a storehouse of all terrorist-related information.

Mission

The mission of the NIA is as follows[4]:

1. In-depth professional investigation of scheduled offences using the latest scientific methods of investigation and setting up such standards as to ensure that all cases entrusted to the NIA are detected.

2. Ensuring effective and speedy trial.

3. Developing into a thoroughly professional, result-oriented organisation, upholding the Constitution of India and laws of the land, giving prime importance to the protection of human rights and dignity of the individual.

4. Developing a professional workforce through regular training and exposure to the best practices and procedures.